

Oona the Owl and the Night Song

A gentle bedtime story for ages 4–7.

Kids Book Videos



In the middle of a mossy old oak lived a little owl named Oona.

Oona was new to the big oak, and she was very small, and she had never hooted a real owl hoot before. When the sun went down and the moon came up, the other owls along the branches puffed their chests and hooted, "Hoo! Hoo!" Their voices were round and deep, like pebbles rolling down a hill.



Oona opened her beak and tried. "Huh... hoo..." It came out all squeaky and small. She shut her beak quickly and tucked her head under her wing.

That night, as she sat quietly on her branch, she began to listen. Really listen.



First she heard the river, far below, humming its low, slow song over the stones. Then the leaves began to whisper to each other, shh-shh, shh-shh, as the night breeze combed through them. A frog by the pond sang a wobbly little song — brrrp! brrrp! — and laughed at his own voice.



Oona leaned out of her hollow and listened harder. There was the mouse, tip-tap-tipping between the roots. There was the moth, soft as a sigh, brushing past her ear. And somewhere high above, the wind sang through the very top branches like a flute.

"Nobody is telling them to sing," Oona thought. "They just... do. In their own way."



She opened her beak again — very gently this time — and let out the tiniest sound: "hoo." It was small, and it was soft, and it floated down through the leaves like a dandelion puff.

The frog stopped his brrrp for a moment and blinked up at her. The mouse paused his tip-tapping. Then the river hummed a little louder, as if it liked her sound, and the leaves whispered back, shh-shh.



So Oona tried once more: "hoo... hoo." A little stronger. A little braver. The night breeze wrapped around her like a warm wing, and her soft hoots joined the river's hum and the leaves' whisper and the frog's wobbly song, and together they made the most beautiful night song the old oak had ever heard.



When the moon had climbed to the very top of the sky, Oona curled her soft feathers around herself and listened to the night song one last time. Every voice was different, and every voice belonged.

Sleep now, little Oona.

The End